# GOVERNMENT FACILITIES SECTOR DESIGN BASIS FRAMEWORK

*Design Basis, Design Basis Accident, and Military-Action Extension Methodology*
*Function-Primary Facility-Class Architecture — the Governance-Continuity Sector*

## DBA-GF: Government Facilities Sector Parent Document

A standalone sector series in the Design Basis for AI Governance in Critical Infrastructure

**Version 0.5 — DRAFT**

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*For review by engineers, regulators, facility-security and continuity officials, and election and policy analysts responsible for the resilience of government operations, judicial function, and election infrastructure.*

**SUGGESTED CITATION**

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*This version is a member of CIKR Design Basis Examples, Edition 1 (November 2026) (https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23863986), a dated edition that freezes, for each of fifteen critical infrastructure sectors, a sector framework, a facility class and a reference event as they stood on 1 November 2026. The edition is not falsified by a later revision of this document, whose working master continues to move. It is a working draft, marked DRAFT on its cover.*

# Section 1 — Purpose, Scope, and Series Architecture

## 1.1 Purpose

This document establishes the Design Basis Framework for the National Infrastructure Protection Plan (NIPP) Government Facilities sector. It is the parent instrument for the DBA-GF series and applies the DB → DBA → DBA-MA three-layer analytical progression to the functions government facilities house: the operation and continuity of government, judicial function, and the conduct of elections.

## 1.2 What This Document Does Not Do

This document does not supersede facility-security standards or the continuity-of-government directives. It does not restate the Bright Line or Command Broker, inherited by reference from FD-BL. For its consumer character it does not re-scope the physical infrastructure its facilities run on: the energy, communications, information technology, transportation, and water they depend on are governed by their own series and inherited here.

## 1.3 Function-Primary Organizing Principle

Placement follows the consequence chain. The sector is organized by the governance function a facility houses — the operation and continuity of government, adjudication, and elections — rather than by the jurisdiction that owns the building, and each function is placed by the governance consequence its loss produces, sub-indexed by level of government and security classification.

## 1.4 Series Placement — DBA-GF as a Standalone Sector Series

DBA-GF is a standalone sector series, a peer of the energy, water, chemical, communications, transportation, financial, healthcare, critical-manufacturing, emergency-services, defense-industrial-base, food-and-agriculture, and nuclear series. It inherits the DB → DBA → DBA-MA methodology from the DBA-MA parent and the Bright Line and Command-Broker architecture from FD-BL, and it applies the mandatory Military-Action Extension Applicability Determination.

## 1.5 A Governance-Continuity Sector with a Symbolic Dimension

Government Facilities is a consumer sector on the model of the financial, healthcare, and emergency-services sectors — its buildings produce no physical commodity and rest on inherited energy, communications, information-technology, and water infrastructure. But its consequence is of a distinctive kind. A government facility's value is the governance function it houses, not the structure itself: the consequence of losing a courthouse is a loss of judicial continuity, of a capitol a loss of legislative continuity, of an operations center a loss of the continuity of government itself. This is a function-continuity consequence in which the function is governance, and continuity of government is its highest-consequence case.

The sector also carries a consequence no other sector has. The sector taxonomy records that many of its facilities hold symbolic value as targets — national monuments, historic landmarks, and symbolic sites are targeted for their psychological and symbolic effect, independent of any functional service they provide. This is the purest attack-for-effect consequence in the framework: the harm is to national morale, legitimacy, and confidence rather than to a delivered service, and it cannot be reduced to a service-continuity metric. The framework carries it as a distinct consequence type. Alongside it, the sector hosts the election-infrastructure subsector, whose consequence — election integrity and availability — connects this framework to the surveillance and democratic-safeguards standard developed elsewhere in the corpus.

# Section 2 — The Government Facilities Sector and Its Regulatory Context

## 2.1 A Security-Standard-Governed, Multi-Level Sector

Government Facilities spans every level of government and is governed by facility-security and information-security standards rather than by an operating regulator. The General Services Administration sets federal facility-management standards; the Interagency Security Committee sets the physical-security standards for federal facilities; the Department of Defense applies its Unified Facilities Criteria to military installations; the Federal Information Security Modernization Act governs the security of federal information systems; and state and local building codes and security practices govern the rest. The Department of Homeland Security and the General Services Administration are the co-Sector Risk Management Agencies, and the Federal Protective Service provides physical protection for many federal facilities.

## 2.2 Standard-and-Function Inheritance

The applicable standard varies by function and level: government-operations facilities inherit the GSA and ISC standards and, where classified, the SCIF and FISMA regime; judicial facilities inherit the ISC standards and the judicial-security apparatus; and election infrastructure inherits the Election Assistance Commission and CISA framework established when election systems were designated critical infrastructure.

## 2.3 The Regulatory Gap

The sector is rich in physical- and information-security standards but carries no design basis stated in governance-continuity terms — no statement of the governance functions the sector must be demonstrated to sustain through a defined envelope of attack and disruption. Security standards are measured in controls and clearances; a design basis measured in demonstrated governance-continuity is absent, and the symbolic-consequence dimension has no design-basis treatment at all.

# Section 3 — Function-Primary Taxonomy

## 3.1 The Function Classes and the Level / Classification Sub-Index

The sector is decomposed into three governance-function classes — government operations and continuity, judicial facilities, and election infrastructure — and one coordination class, the facility-protection-and-continuity layer, with the symbolic-site and specialized-facility dimensions carried as an overlay. Each is sub-indexed by level of government (federal, state, local, tribal) and by security classification.

## 3.2 Government Operations & Continuity (GO)

The government-operations function covers the executive and administrative office buildings, operations centers, and legislative facilities at every level, and the continuity-of-government facilities that preserve the functioning of government under attack. Its governing consequence is loss of the capacity to govern, and continuity of government — the preservation of executive, legislative, and administrative function through a decapitation or catastrophic-disruption scenario — is its bounding case.

## 3.3 Judicial Facilities (JU)

The judicial function covers courthouses and the judicial operations they house. Its governing consequence is loss of judicial continuity and, with it, of the rule-of-law function, and its distinctive design-basis features are the targeted-violence threat against the judiciary and the security of judicial records and proceedings.

## 3.4 Election Infrastructure (EL)

The election function covers the voting systems, tabulation infrastructure, voter-registration databases, and election-management systems designated as critical infrastructure. Its governing consequence is loss of election integrity or availability, and it is the function at which this sector connects most directly to the surveillance and democratic-safeguards standard: an attack on election infrastructure may be a denial of availability, a compromise of integrity, or a covert-influence operation, and the boundary between the infrastructure attack and the influence operation must be stated with that standard.

## 3.5 CntlCo — Facility Protection & Continuity (coordination class)

The coordination function is carried by a coordination class spanning the GSA and ISC standards, the Federal Protective Service, and the continuity-of-government coordination apparatus. This class is designated CntlCo in its widened sense: it covers not only real-time operational control but the mandated custodial control government bodies hold over these facilities — GSA as the federal landlord and operator, the ISC as the setter of mandatory security standards, the Federal Protective Service as the protective force, and the continuity-of-government programs — each exercising a mandated custodial authority over the facilities rather than merely coordinating among them. It is the locus at which the AI-Governance Design Basis is implemented for the sector — the Bright Line placement and Command-Broker obligation for

machine-learning and generative-AI systems in physical access control, video surveillance and intrusion detection, and the analytics increasingly applied to facility security and to election administration.

*† The GO / JU / EL and CntlCo designators were ratified 2026-08-09. Symbolic sites and specialized facilities (military installations, national laboratories, embassies, and schools) are carried as an overlay with boundaries to the defense-industrial-base, research, diplomatic, and education domains.*

### 3.6 Two Consequence Measures

The sector requires two consequence treatments. For the governance functions it adopts a governance-continuity duration — the interval over which a governance function must be preserved or restored through a disruption before the function itself fails, with continuity of government as the bounding calibration. For the symbolic dimension it declines a duration measure entirely: the symbolic consequence is a discrete harm to national morale and legitimacy, not a service outage, and it is measured by the significance of the site rather than by any recovery timeline — a second instance, after the defense sector's exfiltration consequence, of a consequence the corpus cannot express as a duration. *Government Operations and Continuity* (DBA-GF-GO-FC1) states both for the government-operations function: it states the governance-continuity duration as a parameter at class resolution, carries the symbolic consequence as an overlay of three grades declared as a residual rather than bounded, and adds a life-safety chain for the people a government facility holds (*Government Operations and Continuity* §2.2, §3.2, §3.3, §6.8); this framework takes the statement up at its next conformance pass.

## Section 4 — The Government Facilities Sector Design Basis

*[Skeleton — to be developed.] The design envelope will be organized by event category, spanning the governance-continuity and the symbolic consequence dimensions, with a consequence-severity inclusion criterion consistent with the series.*

### 4.1 Design Basis Principles

The criterion for inclusion is governance-consequence severity — potential for loss of the continuity of government, of judicial function, or of election integrity, or for a symbolic harm to national legitimacy — not event likelihood. Candidate bounding events, to be developed: a continuity-of-government decapitation scenario; loss or targeted attack of a judicial facility; an attack on election infrastructure across the availability, integrity, or influence dimensions; and a symbolic-site attack whose consequence is measured in national morale rather than service loss.

## Section 5 — Dual Design Basis: Bright Line and Command Broker

*[Skeleton — to be developed on the DBA-W §5.5 model.]*

Government facilities are deploying AI in physical security — video analytics, intrusion detection, and access control — and, in the election domain, in administration and integrity

analytics. The Bright Line must be placed for any action of a component within scope of FD-LD §4.3 whose incorrect performance could compromise facility security, governance continuity, or election integrity at or above the severity threshold, with the architecturally enforced authorization of a qualified security or election official as Command Broker. The election application is the most sensitive: any AI system touching tabulation or voter-registration integrity sits at the highest-consequence tier and must be treated with the surveillance standard as well as the Bright Line. Determinism decides scope under FD-LD §4.3; it does not decide placement.

# Section 6 — Cross-Sector Dependencies and the Consequence Elevation Rule

## 6.1 Inward View — the Facility Dependencies

Government Facilities depends on energy for building operations, on communications for government networks and public services, on information technology for its information systems and its classified networks, on transportation for employee and public access, and on water for facility operation. As a consumer sector it inherits these from their series, and the classified-network dependency ties it to the data-center and communications series with the same security overlay the defense sector carries.

## 6.2 Outward View — Governance and Legitimacy

The outward consequence of the sector is the functioning of government itself, and it is therefore felt across the whole of society rather than through a single service chain: a loss of governance continuity degrades the coordination of every emergency and every other sector's recovery, and a loss of election integrity or a symbolic strike degrades the legitimacy and confidence on which governance rests. This sector's consequence is the most diffuse and the most fundamental in the framework.

## 6.3 Named Boundaries

Three boundaries are named. Military installations and national laboratories appear in this sector as facilities but are governed for their defense-production and research functions by the defense-industrial-base series; the boundary runs at the point where the consequence shifts from the facility to the capability it produces. Emergency operations centers are Emergency Services, not Government Facilities. And the election-integrity consequence is shared with the surveillance and democratic-safeguards standard, which governs the influence dimension that the infrastructure attack does not.

# Section 7 — Military-Action Extension Applicability

*[Skeleton.] Government Facilities is a first-order military-action target: continuity-of-government decapitation, the attack on judicial and legislative function, the symbolic strike, and the compromise of election infrastructure are all recognized objectives of deliberate adversarial action. The sector-level*

*presumption toward MA applicability is strong for continuity-of-government facilities, symbolic national sites, and election infrastructure. Application remains a per-facility determination under the mandatory two-factor test — geolocation and strategic value — with strategic value driven by the governance function preserved and by symbolic significance.*

# Section 8 — Facility Class Register and Inheritance Model

## 8.1 Inheritance Model

Facility-class instruments of every type in the DBA-GF series inherit the threat taxonomy, bounding methodology, consequence-analysis structure, adequacy standards, and Bright Line / Command-Broker architecture established in this framework, and — as a consumer sector — inherit the physical design basis of their substrate from the energy, communications, information-technology, transportation, and water series. Each instrument adds the governance-function-specific consequence chain and, where applicable, the symbolic consequence.

## 8.2 Facility Class Register

The following table is the current facility-class register for the DBA-GF series. DBA-GF-GO-FC1 has issued as a working draft and the other governance-function classes are at Anticipated status, with symbolic sites and specialized facilities carried as an overlay. Designators were ratified 2026-08-09 and are sub-indexed by level of government and security classification.

| Designator | Function class (function-primary) | Governing characteristic | Status | Primary regulatory anchor |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| DBA-GF-GO-FC1 | Government operations & continuity — executive/administrative buildings, operations centers, continuity-of-government facilities, capitols (federal/state/local/tribal) | loss of governance function; continuity of government | Issued (working draft) | GSA; ISC; DHS FPS |
| DBA-GF-JU-FC2 | Judicial facilities — courthouses and judicial operations | judicial continuity; rule of law | Anticipated | GSA; ISC; U.S. Marshals |
| DBA-GF-EL-FC3 | Election infrastructure — voting systems, tabulation, voter registration, election management | election integrity & availability | Anticipated | EAC; CISA; Surveillance-sibling boundary |
| DBA-GF-CntlCo† | Facility protection & continuity (coordination class) — GSA / ISC standards, FPS, continuity-of-government coordination | physical security & continuity coordination | Anticipated (architecture) | GSA; ISC; DHS FPS; FISMA |
| (overlay / boundary) | Symbolic sites (national monuments & icons); specialized facilities — military installations (→ DBA-DIB), national labs, embassies, schools | symbolic-target value; specialized boundaries | Anticipated (overlay) | NPS; DoD; State; Education subsector |

*Designators were ratified 2026-08-09. Facility-class numbers are sequential across the series; CntlCo is a coordination class and carries no FC number, mirroring DBA-ES-CntlCo. Grounded in the CIKR_v16 sector map (Government Facilities Core Infrastructure and Operational Characteristics).*

# Section 9 — Development Status and Open Items

This is the initial working draft of the DBA-GF sector framework, grounded in the CIKR_v16 sector map. It establishes the standalone-series placement, the governance-continuity consequence and the distinct symbolic-target consequence, the function-primary decomposition (government operations and continuity, judicial facilities, election infrastructure, and the CntlCo facility-protection-and-continuity class) with a level-and-classification sub-index and a symbolic-site overlay, and the boundaries to the defense-industrial-base, emergency-services, and surveillance domains. The design-basis envelope (Section 4), the dual-DB detail (Section 5), and the MA applicability section (Section 7) are stubs to be developed. Open items at this version: develop the governance-continuity measure and the non-duration symbolic consequence; and reconcile the election-integrity boundary with the surveillance standard and the military-installation boundary with DBA-DIB. At v0.4, the series' first facility class has issued: DBA-GF-GO-FC1 (*Government Operations and Continuity*), a coordination class on the author's determination of 14 October 2026, which confirmed the type given on 30 September 2026 (*Government Operations and Continuity* §1.4), and the three reference events it proposed are conferred at Section 9.1. It develops, for the government-operations function, the two consequence measures of Section 3.6 and the candidate bounding events of Section 4.1. What it notes to this framework is taken up at the framework's next conformance pass: the three chains and the life-safety chain in particular, the six parameters and the governance-continuity duration at class resolution, the continuity tiers and the symbolic overlay, the event categories it develops ahead of Section 4, the Continuity of Function and Protected Occupancy Conditions, its declared residuals and the consequence-basis conditionality check (*Government Operations and Continuity* §10.9). The cover of v0.3 was dated August 2026 although that version was made in October 2026; v0.4 is dated October 2026. At v0.4 the Department of Homeland Security and the General Services Administration are named co-Sector Risk Management Agencies, the current name of the role and its current holders, at Section 2.1 and in the references (*Government Operations and Continuity* §10.5). Further open item: the three reference-event instruments of Section 9.1.

## 9.1 Conferred Reference Events

On the author's decision of 14 October 2026, this framework confers a reference-event designator on each of the three events its first facility class proposed. A designator commits the series to two things: a row in the corpus-wide DBA Reference Event Register, and a standalone reference-event instrument for that event. Under the determination of 9 October 2026 (*Reference Events Move to Their Own Project*), reference-event instruments are written and held by Project 11, DBA Reference Events; this framework keeps the conferral. None of the three instruments is yet written. The designators are numbered in the order the proposing class lists its events; the number records conferral, not issue. Each designator is sector-primary and single.

From *Government Operations and Continuity*, three events are conferred: DBA-GF-RE-1, the bombing of the Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building in Oklahoma City on 19 April 1995; DBA-GF-RE-2, the breach of the United States Capitol on 6 January 2021, during the joint session

convened to count the electoral votes, whose official accounts differ and are each stated as their authors' own; and DBA-GF-RE-3, the ransomware attack on the City of Atlanta disclosed on 22 March 2018, on the city's and the Department of Justice's accounts. The breach of the Illinois voter-registration system in 2016, which the plan for closing the seven sectors named for this sector, is held for *Election Infrastructure* (DBA-GF-EL-FC3) and is not conferred here. The strike on the building of Ukraine's Cabinet of Ministers on 7 September 2025 and the anthrax letters of October 2001, which the class notes, are not conferred. The three instruments are owed, and they are Project 11's to write. *Government Operations and Continuity* states the three as proposed at its v0.1 and conforms to the conferral at its next revision.

This framework is still a skeleton at Sections 4, 5 and 7. The three instruments read their events back through the design basis of *Government Operations and Continuity*, which develops it ahead of the framework, and what they return to the framework is taken up at its next conformance pass.

## References

*[To be completed.] Governing and inherited instruments: FD-BL and determination annexes; DBA-MA Parent Framework (IAEA L1); DBA Series Gaps and Recommendations (§1.7, MA applicability); DBA-EN / DBA-COMM / DBA-DC / DBA-TRAN / DBA-W (facility substrate); DBA-DIB (military-installation and national-laboratory boundary; non-recoverable-consequence precedent); the surveillance and democratic-safeguards standard (Project 1, election-integrity boundary). Regulatory: DHS and GSA (co-SRMAs) and FPS; GSA; ISC; DoD Unified Facilities Criteria; FISMA; EAC and CISA (election infrastructure). Grounding: CIKR_v16 sector map (Government Facilities Sector).* Series instruments: DBA-GF-GO-FC1 (*Government Operations and Continuity*), the series' first facility class; DBA-GF-RE-1 to DBA-GF-RE-3, the conferred reference events of Section 9.1, their instruments owed to Project 11.

## Revision History

**0.5** November 2026 — T. Roxey. Corrects the type of DBA-GF-GO-FC1 (Government Operations and Continuity) in the development status, which v0.4 called physical. The class itself, at v0.2 §1.4, states that it is a coordination class on the author's determination of 14 October 2026, which confirmed the type given on 30 September 2026; the framework had not followed. The register row carries no type and is unchanged. No requirement, event category, parameter or finding changed. Made on the author's instruction of 1 November 2026, so that the framework is not frozen with the error in the first edition of Project 0's public site of CIKR design basis examples.

**0.4** October 2026 — T. Roxey. Section 9.1 is added and confers DBA-GF-RE-1 to DBA-GF-RE-3 on the three reference events that DBA-GF-GO-FC1 (Government Operations and Continuity) proposed, on the author's decision of 14 October 2026: the Oklahoma City bombing (1995), the breach of the Capitol (2021) and the ransomware attack on the City of Atlanta (2018). The Illinois voter-registration breach (2016) is held for the election class. Each

designator commits the series to a register row and a standalone instrument, none yet written; the instruments are Project 11's. The register at Section 8.2 enters the class as issued. Section 3.6 records the class's statement of the two consequence measures for the government-operations function. Section 9 records the class's issue, what it notes to this framework, the correction of the cover date and the agency's name. The cover now reads October 2026; v0.3's cover read August 2026 although v0.3 was made in October. The Department of Homeland Security and the General Services Administration are named co-Sector Risk Management Agencies at Section 2.1 and in the references. References add the class and the three designators. No change to the taxonomy, the designators of the classes, the sub-index or the design basis. Revision-history entries are left as records.

**0.3** October 2026 — T. Roxey. Conformed to the October 2026 Edition of the Foundational Definitions on Project 0's work order of 3 October 2026. Section 5 states the scope of Bright Line placement by the determinism carve-out of FD-LD §4.3 rather than as any AI action, and states that determinism decides scope and not placement (P9-11, wording). Functional class is retired at every site under the author's determination of 30 September 2026, each site read for its sense: the decomposition tier reads function class, and the coordination layer reads coordination class (OI-15). No change to the design basis, the taxonomy or the register.

**0.2** August 2026 — T. Roxey. Designators ratified; coordination class resolved to CntlCo (widened to mandated custodial control — GSA / ISC / FPS / COG); GO / JU / EL confirmed; governance-continuity and symbolic-target consequences confirmed.

**0.1** August 2026 — T. Roxey. Initial skeleton, grounded in the CIKR_v16 sector map. Established DBA-GF as a standalone sector series with a governance-continuity consequence (the value is the function housed, not the structure; continuity of government is the bounding case) and a distinct symbolic-target consequence (attack-for-effect against monuments and icons — a second non-duration consequence type after the defense sector's exfiltration). Adopted the function-primary decomposition (Government Operations & Continuity / Judicial Facilities / Election Infrastructure / CntlCo facility-protection-and-continuity) with a level-and-classification sub-index and a symbolic-site and specialized-facility overlay; named the DBA-DIB (military installation / national lab), Emergency-Services (EOC), and surveillance-standard (election integrity) boundaries. Design-basis envelope, dual-DB detail, and MA applicability sections stubbed for development.